

PHILOSOPHY PAPER II — PHILOSOPHY OF RELIGION 01 — NOTIONS OF GOD

CONTROL QUESTION AND CONCEPTUAL → WESTERN RELATION MODELS → DIVINE ATTRIBUTES UNDER COHERENCE → SPINOZA: DEUS SIVE NATURA → ADVAITA: NIRGUṆA, SAGUṆA AND → RĀMĀNUJA: ORGANIC UNITY

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g11 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 CONTROL QUESTION AND CONCEPTUAL AXES

CONTROL QUESTION AND CONCEPTUAL AXES

NOTIONS OF GOD

WHAT KIND OF REALITY IS CALLED "GOD", AND HOW

TRANSPERSONAL ATTRIBUTES

SIMPLICITY RELATION

NATURE AXIS

PERSONAL ↔ IMPERSONAL

RELATION AXIS

NOTIONS OF GOD

What kind of reality is called "God", and how is it related to man and

nature: personal / impersonal / transpersonal attributes: power / knowledge / goodness / eternity /

/ God-man / transcendence / immanence

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- NOTIONS OF GOD
- What kind of reality is called "God", and how is it related to man and the world?
- nature: personal / impersonal / transpersonal attributes: power / knowledge / goodness / eternity / simplicity relation: God-world

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- / God-man / transcendence / immanence
- NATURE AXIS: personal ↔ impersonal
- RELATION AXIS: transcendent ↔ immanent cataphatic affirmation + apophatic negation → analogical control too much affirmation = anthropomorphism

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- too much negation = empty God-talk.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — High-value transition: Personal/impersonal and transcendent/immanent are independent analytical axes; do not turn them into bodily/spatial claims.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: High-value transition: Personal/impersonal and transcendent/immanent are independent analytical axes; do not turn them into bodily/spatial claims.

01

STAGE 01 WESTERN RELATION MODELS

WESTERN RELATION MODELS

WESTERN NOTIONS

PERSONAL NECESSARY CREATOR: DISTINCT, SUSTAINING, PROVIDENTIAL

NATURAL LAW

WITHDRAWAL; MIRACLES/REVELATION WEAKENED

WORLD IS IN GOD, BUT GOD EXCEEDS WORLD

PROCESS/DIPOLAR GOD ABSTRACT POLE

ETERNAL POSSIBILITIES + STABLE CHARACTER CONSEQUENT POLE

WESTERN NOTIONS

THEISM: personal necessary Creator; distinct, sustaining, providential

DEISM: creation → natural law → withdrawal; miracles/revelation weakened

PANTHEISM: God = world/nature

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- WESTERN NOTIONS
- THEISM: personal necessary Creator; distinct, sustaining, providential
- DEISM: creation → natural law → withdrawal; miracles/revelation weakened

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- PANTHEISM: God = world/nature
- PANENTHEISM: world is in God, but God exceeds world
- PROCESS/DIPOLAR GOD abstract pole: eternal possibilities + stable character consequent pole: receives changing world and experience persuasion protects

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- freedom, but revises omnipotence and immutability.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — High-value transition: Doctrine statement. God is a necessary, personal creator, distinct from yet continuously sustaining the world, traditionally described as omnipotent, omniscient, perfectly good, eternal, immutable and simple.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: High-value transition: Doctrine statement. God is a necessary, personal creator, distinct from yet continuously sustaining the world, traditionally described as omnipotent, omniscient, perfectly good, eternal, immutable and simple.

02

STAGE 02 DIVINE ATTRIBUTES UNDER COHERENCE PRESSURE

DIVINE ATTRIBUTES UNDER COHERENCE PRESSURE

ETERNITY IMMUTABILITY

ASEITY OMNIPOTENCE

LOGICALLY POSSIBLE ACTS; CONTRADICTIONS ARE NOT OBJECTS OF POWER

OPEN THEISM GOODNESS + POWER + KNOWLEDGE + EVIL

JOINT COMPATIBILITY PRESSURE SIMPLICITY

NO PARTS; ESSENCE

EXISTENCE; ATTRIBUTES NOT SEPARABLE COMPONENTS OBJECTION

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

ATTRIBUTES: omnipotence

eternity immutability

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

aseity omnipotence → logically possible acts; contradictions are not objects of power foreknowledge vs freedom → Boethius

open theism goodness + power + knowledge + evil → joint compatibility pressure simplicity → no parts

REPLY / RESIDUAL

essence = existence

attributes not separable components objection: can identical attributes permit free, personal relation to changing creatures?

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- ATTRIBUTES: omnipotence

- eternity immutability

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- aseity omnipotence → logically possible acts; contradictions are not objects of power foreknowledge vs freedom → Boethius

- open theism goodness + power + knowledge + evil → joint compatibility pressure simplicity → no parts

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- essence = existence

- attributes not separable components objection: can identical attributes permit free, personal relation to changing creatures?

EXISTENCE; ATTRIBUTES NOT SEPARABLE COMPONENTS OBJECTION		
DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
ATTRIBUTES: omnipotence eternity immutability	aseity omnipotence → logically possible acts; contradictions are not objects of power foreknowledge vs freedom → Boethius open theism goodness + power + knowledge + evil → joint compatibility pressure simplicity → no parts	essence = existence attributes not separable components objection: can identical attributes permit free, personal relation to changing creatures?
DOCTRINE / CLAIM - ATTRIBUTES: omnipotence - eternity immutability	OBJECTION / PRESSURE - aseity omnipotence → logically possible acts; contradictions are not objects of power foreknowledge vs freedom → Boethius - open theism goodness + power + knowledge + evil → joint compatibility pressure simplicity → no parts	REPLY / RESIDUAL - essence = existence - attributes not separable components objection: can identical attributes permit free, personal relation to changing creatures?
MECHANISM / VERDICT — Major criticism: The classical attributes generate pressure when unlimited power, complete foreknowledge, perfect goodness and creaturely freedom are asserted without qualification.		
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Major criticism: The classical attributes generate pressure when unlimited power, complete foreknowledge, perfect goodness and creaturely freedom are asserted without qualification.		

03

STAGE 03

DEUS SIVE NATURA

DEUS SIVE NATURA

ONE INFINITE SUBSTANCE

INFINITE EXPRESSION MODES

FINITE MINDS AND BODIES HUMANS KNOW THOUGHT AND EXTENSION

PERSONALITY, PROVIDENCE AND FREE WILL DISAPPEAR REPLY

SELF-DETERMINED ACTION FROM ONE'S OWN NATURE, NOT ARBITRARY CHOICE.

DEUS SIVE NATURA → ONE INFINITE SUBSTANCE

ATTRIBUTES: infinite expression MODES: finite minds and bodies humans know Thought and Extension depend on

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DEUS SIVE NATURA → ONE INFINITE SUBSTANCE
- ATTRIBUTES: infinite expression MODES: finite minds and bodies humans know Thought and Extension depend on the one substance

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- God does not choose to create radically immanent, not a personal ruler outside nature objection: personality, providence and
- DEUS SIVE NATURA → ONE INFINITE SUBSTANCE

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ATTRIBUTES: infinite expression MODES: finite minds and bodies humans know Thought and Extension depend on the one substance
- God does not choose to create radically immanent, not a personal ruler outside nature objection: personality, providence and

MECHANISM / VERDICT

High-value transition: Everything follows necessarily from divine nature.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: High-value transition: Everything follows necessarily from divine nature.

04

STAGE 04

ADVAITA: NIRGUṆA, SAGUṆA AND VIVARTA

NIRGUṆA, SAGUṆA AND VIVARTA

ONE NON-DUAL BRAHMAN

BEYOND LIMITING PREDICATES; PĀRAMĀRTHIKA; SAT-CIT-ĀNANDA

SAGUṆA ĪŚVARA

PERSONAL LORD; CREATOR/RULER; VYĀVAHĀRIKA; DEVOTION

BRAHMAN + MĀYĀ

EXPERIENCED WORLD THROUGH VIVARTA, APPARENT TRANSFORMATION ROPE APPEARS SNAKE

LIBERATION KNOWS AN ALREADY-EXISTING IDENTITY

ONE NON-DUAL BRAHMAN

NIRGUṆA: beyond limiting predicates; pāramārthika; Sat-Cit-Ānanda

SAGUṆA ĪŚVARA: personal Lord; creator/ruler; vyāvahārika; devotion

Brahman + māyā → experienced world through VIVARTA, apparent transformation rope appears snake; Brahman undergoes

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ONE NON-DUAL BRAHMAN
- NIRGUṆA: beyond limiting predicates; pāramārthika; Sat-Cit-Ānanda

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- SAGUṆA ĪŚVARA: personal Lord; creator/ruler; vyāvahārika; devotion
- Brahman + māyā → experienced world through VIVARTA, apparent transformation rope appears snake; Brahman undergoes no real change

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ĀTMAN = BRAHMAN → liberation knows an already-existing identity
- TRAP: anirvacaniya properly marks māyā/world appearance, not nirguṇa Brahman itself.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

anirvacaniya properly marks māyā/world appearance, not nirguṇa Brahman itself.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: anirvacaniya properly marks māyā/world appearance, not nirguṇa Brahman itself.

05

STAGE 05

RĀMĀNUJA: ORGANIC UNITY

ORGANIC UNITY

PERSONAL SAGUṆA BRAHMAN, NĀRĀYAṆA

CIT (SELVES) + ACIT (MATTER)

REAL QUALIFICATIONS OF BRAHMAN

WORLD/SOULS ARE BODY; BRAHMAN IS INDWELLING CONTROLLER

INSEPARABLE DEPENDENCE WITHOUT NUMERICAL IDENTITY

MATERIAL AND EFFICIENT CAUSE; WORLD IS REAL PARIṆĀMA JĪVA

LIBERATION OBJECTION

VIŚIṢṬĀDVAITA → personal saguṇa Brahman, Nārāyaṇa

CIT (selves) + ACIT (matter) = real qualifications of Brahman

ŚARĪRA-ŚARĪRI: world/souls are body; Brahman is indwelling controller

APRTHAK-SIDDHI: inseparable dependence without numerical identity

God = material and efficient cause

05

STAGE 05

RĀMĀNUJA: ORGANIC UNITY

ORGANIC UNITY

PERSONAL SAGUṆA BRAHMAN, NĀRĀYAṆA

CIT (SELVES) + ACIT (MATTER)

REAL QUALIFICATIONS OF BRAHMAN

WORLD/SOULS ARE BODY; BRAHMAN IS INDWELLING CONTROLLER

INSEPARABLE DEPENDENCE WITHOUT NUMERICAL IDENTITY

MATERIAL AND EFFICIENT CAUSE; WORLD IS REAL PARINĀMA JĪVA

LIBERATION OBJECTION

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ŚARĪRA-ŚARĪRI: world/souls are body; Brahman is indwelling controller

APRTHAK-SIDDHI: inseparable dependence without numerical identity

God = material and efficient cause

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• VIŚIṢṬĀDVAITA → personal saguṇa Brahman, Nārāyaṇa

• CIT (selves) + ACIT (matter) = real qualifications of Brahman

• ŚARĪRA-ŚARĪRI: world/souls are body; Brahman is indwelling controller

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• APRTHAK-SIDDHI: inseparable dependence without numerical identity

• God = material and efficient cause

• world is real PARINĀMA jiva → dependence → bhakti → prapatti → liberation objection: do bodily defects taint God?

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• reply: defects belong to controlled body.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — High-value transition: Real manifestation/parināma (real transformation); bhakti and prapatti; liberation is service/communion, not absorption.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: High-value transition: Real manifestation/parināma (real transformation); bhakti and prapatti; liberation is service/communion, not absorption.

06

STAGE 06

NYĀYA AND HINDU DIVINE PLURALITY

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NYĀYA ĪŚVARA

GOD + SELVES + ATOMS + SPACE/TIME ARE REAL

GOD IS EFFICIENT CAUSE; ETERNAL ATOMS ARE MATERIAL CAUSES

DIVINE COORDINATION

FITTING RESULTS; SELVES REMAIN DISTINCT

"IS HINDUISM POLYTHEISTIC?" POLYTHEISM

RGVEDA 1.164.46

God is efficient cause; eternal atoms are material causes karma/adrṣṭa → divine coordination → fitting

NYĀYA ĪŚVARA: God + selves + atoms + space/time are real

"IS HINDUISM POLYTHEISTIC?" polytheism

Rgveda 1.164.46: reality is one; sages speak of it variously verdict: many-deity practice, one-deity praise

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• NYĀYA ĪŚVARA: God + selves + atoms + space/time are real

• God is efficient cause; eternal atoms are material causes karma/adrṣṭa → divine coordination → fitting results; selves remain distinct

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• "IS HINDUISM POLYTHEISTIC?" polytheism

• Rgveda 1.164.46: reality is one; sages speak of it variously verdict: many-deity practice, one-deity praise, sectarian supremacy and

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• Upaniṣadic monism coexist; one label cannot exhaust all levels.

• NYĀYA ĪŚVARA: God + selves + atoms + space/time are real

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Rgveda 1.164.46: reality is one; sages speak of it variously verdict: many-deity practice, one-deity praise, sectarian supremacy and

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: reality is one; sages speak of it variously verdict: many-deity practice, one-deity praise, sectarian supremacy and.

07

STAGE 07

COMPARATIVE GOD-WORLD-MAN MATRIX

COMPARATIVE GOD-WORLD-MAN MATRIX

SYSTEM GOD-WORLD GOD-MAN

THEISM CREATOR AND SUSTAINER WORSHIP, PROVIDENCE, GRACE

DEISM CREATOR WHO WITHDRAWS REMOTE RATIONAL SOURCE

SPINOZA GOD

NATURE PERSON IS FINITE MODE

ADVAITA WORLD IS VIVARTA ĀTMAN

RĀMĀNUJA WORLD IS GOD'S REAL BODY DISTINCT YET INSEPARABLY

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
SYSTEM GOD-WORLD GOD-MAN	Spinoza God = Nature person is finite mode	Nyāya God orders eternal atoms distinct soul under moral governance ultimate cause need not be physical: spatial/material dependence limits ultimacy
Theism creator and sustainer worship, providence, grace	Advaita world is vivarta ātman = Brahman	pantheism and Rāmānuja qualify this without requiring an anthropomorphic body.
Deism creator who withdraws remote rational source	Rāmānuja world is God's real body distinct yet inseparably dependent	

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• SYSTEM GOD-WORLD GOD-MAN

• Theism creator and sustainer worship, providence, grace

• Deism creator who withdraws remote rational source

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

• Spinoza God = Nature person is finite mode

• Advaita world is vivarta ātman = Brahman

• Rāmānuja world is God's real body distinct yet inseparably dependent

EVALUATION / TRAP

• Nyāya God orders eternal atoms distinct soul under moral governance ultimate cause need not be physical: spatial/material dependence limits ultimacy

• pantheism and Rāmānuja qualify this without requiring an anthropomorphic body.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: When Brahman (ultimate reality) is understood in relation to maya (cosmic appearance and power of projection), it is Isvara (Lord or personal God) - the omniscient and omnipotent creator, sustainer and dissolver of the empirical world.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: When Brahman (ultimate reality) is understood in relation to maya (cosmic appearance and power of projection), it is Isvara (Lord or personal God) - the omniscient and omnipotent creator, sustainer and dissolver of the empirical world.

08

STAGE 08

EXAMINER TRAPS AND PYQ ROUTES

- Deism creator who withdraws remote rational source
- Rāmānuja world is God's real body distinct yet inseparably dependent
- pantheism and Rāmānuja qualify this without requiring an anthropomorphic body.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: When Brahman (ultimate reality) is understood in relation to maya (cosmic appearance and power of projection), it is Isvara (Lord or personal God) - the omniscient and omnipotent creator, sustainer and dissolver of the empirical world.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — **WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:** Recommended opening definition: When Brahman (ultimate reality) is understood in relation to maya (cosmic appearance and power of projection), it is Isvara (Lord or personal God) - the omniscient and omnipotent creator, sustainer and dissolver of the empirical world.

08

STAGE 08

EXAMINER TRAPS AND PYQ ROUTES

EXAMINER TRAPS AND PYQ ROUTES

SPATIALLY REMOTE IMMANENT

NON-EXISTENT APRTHAK-SIDDHI

NYĀYA GOD

EFFICIENT CAUSE

PYQ ROUTES PERSONAL/IMPERSONAL

THEISM + SPINOZA + SAGUṆA/NIRGUṆA

DEVOTION FREEDOM/GOD

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
TRAPS: personal != anthropomorphic	nirguṇa != non-existent aprthak-siddhi != identity	PYQ ROUTES personal/impersonal → theism + Spinoza + saguṇa/nirguṇa
transcendent != spatially remote immanent != pantheistic	Nyāya God = efficient cause	Spinoza → substance → attributes → modes → necessity → criticism
pantheism != panentheism	monism != monotheism	Rāmānuja → cit/acit → body-soul → aprthak-siddhi → devotion freedom/God → foreknowledge problem → named solutions → qualified verdict.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- TRAPS: personal != anthropomorphic
- transcendent != spatially remote immanent != pantheistic
- pantheism != panentheism

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- nirguṇa != non-existent aprthak-siddhi != identity
- Nyāya God = efficient cause
- monism != monotheism

EVALUATION / TRAP

- PYQ ROUTES personal/impersonal → theism + Spinoza + saguṇa/nirguṇa
- Spinoza → substance → attributes → modes → necessity → criticism
- Rāmānuja → cit/acit → body-soul → aprthak-siddhi → devotion freedom/God → foreknowledge problem → named solutions → qualified verdict.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Rāmānuja → cit/acit → body-soul → aprthak-siddhi → devotion freedom/God → foreknowledge problem → named solutions → qualified verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — **WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:** Rāmānuja → cit/acit → body-soul → aprthak-siddhi → devotion freedom/God → foreknowledge problem → named solutions → qualified verdict.

09

STAGE 09

ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

DEFINE EXACT GOD-CONCEPT

STATE METAPHYSICAL MODEL

EXPLAIN GOD-WORLD AND GOD-MAN RELATIONS

USE EXACT SCHOOL TERMINOLOGY

STRONGEST OBJECTION

STRONGEST REPLY

SAME-AXIS COMPARISON

define exact God-concept → state metaphysical model

→

explain God-world and God-man relations → use exact school terminology

→

strongest objection → strongest reply → same-axis comparison

→

qualified philosophical verdict

→

God is a family of models: perfect person, infinite substance, non-dual consciousness, organic unity or

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- define exact God-concept → state metaphysical model
- explain God-world and God-man relations → use exact school terminology

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- strongest objection → strongest reply → same-axis comparison
- qualified philosophical verdict

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- God is a family of models: perfect person, infinite substance, non-dual consciousness, organic unity or intelligent ordering.
- Adequacy turns on nature + attributes + relations coherence: whether ultimacy best preserves agency, unity, devotion, independence, moral

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Final verdict: "The notion of God is not a single universal concept but a family of metaphysical models.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — **WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:** Final verdict: "The notion of God is not a single universal concept but a family of metaphysical models.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

ENRICHMENT — EXTRA DEPTH, NEVER A PREREQUISITE FOR THE

WESTERN AND ABRAHAMIC REFERENCE STANDARDS

INDIAN SCHOOL-SPECIFIC COMPARISON

CRITIQUE, LANGUAGE AND PRACTICAL CONSEQUENCES

EXTERNAL PHILOSOPHY OF RELIGION DOSSIER

TOPIC 1 — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

CREATION EX NIHILO MEANS DEPENDENCE ON DIVINE AGENCY WITHOUT

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- ADVANCED / ENRICHMENT — extra depth, never a prerequisite for the verified PYQs
- Western and Abrahamic Reference Standards
- Indian School-Specific Comparison
- Critique, Language and Practical Consequences

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- External Philosophy of Religion dossier: Topic 1 — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- Creation ex nihilo means dependence on divine agency without independent primordial material; "nothing" is not a material cause.
- Emanation treats finite reality as proceeding from the source, often with stronger necessity and weaker choice.
- Panentheism places the world within divine life while holding that God exceeds it.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Efficient causation need not require physical manifestation.
- Ramanuja's body-language expresses dependence and governance, not a finite divine organism.
- Augustine: creator, eternal truth, goodness and providential personal relation.
- Anselm: perfect-being grammar; use its attribute implications here, not the proof.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.